

Title: Investigating addressing Modes using C code

Theory:

Addressing modes are techniques used by the CPU to identify the location of the operand(s) needed for executing an instruction. They provide rules for interpreting the address field in an instruction, helping the CPU fetch operands correctly.

The types of addressing modes includes

- Implicit addressing : The instruction does not mention the operand directly. The CPU knows what to use from the instruction itself, usually a special register like the accumulator or the stack. It is used for special instructions or control commands like CLA, PUSH, and RET, where the operand is automatically known from the instruction itself
- Immediate addressing: The operand is the part of the instruction itself. It is used when the value is known while writing the program
- Direct addressing: The instruction contains the memory address of the operand. The CPU accesses the data directly from that address.
- Indirect addressing: The instruction contains the address of a memory location, which itself stores the actual address of the operand. The CPU first accesses this memory location to get the effective address, and then fetches the operand.
- Register addressing: The operand is located in a CPU register specified by the instruction.
- Register indirect addressing: The register specified in the instruction contains the memory address of the operand.
- Displacement addressing: The operand's effective address is calculated by adding a constant value (displacement) to the contents of one or more registers.
- Stack addressing: The operand is implicitly taken from the top of the stack, without being mentioned in the instruction

Implementation:

```
6 void function_example() {
0x00000000000001169 <+0>: endbr64
0x0000000000000116d <+4>: push %rbp
0x0000000000000116e <+5>: mov %rsp,%rbp
0x00000000000001171 <+8>: sub $0x60,%rsp
0x00000000000001175 <+12>: mov %fs:0x28,%rax
0x0000000000000117e <+21>: mov %rax,-0x8(%rbp)
0x00000000000001182 <+25>: xor %eax,%eax

7 // Stack Addressing (local variables)
8 int x = 5;
0x00000000000001184 <+27>: movl $0x5,-0x54(%rbp)

9 int y = 10;
0x0000000000000118b <+34>: movl $0xa,-0x4c(%rbp)

10 // Immediate Addressing
11 int a = 20;
12 0x00000000000001192 <+41>: movl $0x14,-0x58(%rbp)

13 // Register Direct (normal variable use)
14 int b = a;
15 0x00000000000001199 <+48>: mov -0x58(%rbp),%eax
0x0000000000000119c <+51>: mov %eax,-0x48(%rbp)

16 // Indirect Addressing
17 int *p = &a;
18 0x0000000000000119f <+54>: lea -0x58(%rbp),%rax
0x000000000000011a3 <+58>: mov %rax,-0x30(%rbp)
```

GDB Output

```
#include <stdio.h>
// Direct Addressing (global variable)
int global_var = 50;

void function_example() {
// Stack Addressing (local variables)
int x = 5;
int y = 10;

// Immediate Addressing
int a = 20;

// Register Direct (normal variable use)
int b = a;

// Indirect Addressing
int *p = &a;

// Register Indirect
int c = *p;

// Indexed Addressing
int arr[5] = {1,2,3,4,5};
int d = arr[2];

// Base Register Addressing (array + pointer)
int *base = arr;
int e = *(base + 3);

// Relative Addressing (loop / control flow)
for(int i = 0; i < 3; i++) {
x += i;
}

// Auto-increment
int f = 0;
f = arr[f++];

// Auto-decrement
int g = 2;
g = arr[--g];

// Print to avoid optimization
printf("x: %d y: %d z: %d\n", b, c, d, e, f, g, global_var);
}

int main() {
function_example();
return 0;
}
```

Used Code

```
22
23 // Indexed Addressing
24 int arr[5] = {1,2,3,4,5};
0x00000000000011b0 <+71>: movl $0x1,-0x20(%rbp)
0x00000000000011b7 <+78>: movl $0x2,-0x1c(%rbp)
0x00000000000011be <+85>: movl $0x3,-0x18(%rbp)
0x00000000000011c5 <+92>: movl $0x4,-0x14(%rbp)
0x00000000000011cc <+99>: movl $0x5,-0x10(%rbp)

25 int d = arr[2];
0x00000000000011d3 <+106>: mov -0x18(%rbp),%eax
0x00000000000011d6 <+109>: mov %eax,-0x40(%rbp)
--Type <RET> for more, q to quit, c to continue without paging--

26 // Base Register Addressing (array + pointer)
27 int *base = arr;
28 0x00000000000011d9 <+112>: lea -0x20(%rbp),%rax
0x00000000000011dd <+116>: mov %rax,-0x28(%rbp)

29 int e = *(base + 3);
0x00000000000011e1 <+120>: mov -0x28(%rbp),%rax
0x00000000000011e5 <+124>: mov 0xc(%rax),%eax
0x00000000000011e8 <+127>: mov %eax,-0x3c(%rbp)

30 // Relative Addressing (loop / control flow)
31 for(int i = 0; i < 3; i++) {
32 0x00000000000011eb <+130>: movl $0x0,-0x50(%rbp)
0x00000000000011f2 <+137>: jmp 0x11fe <function_example+

33 x += i;
0x00000000000011f4 <+139>: mov -0x50(%rbp),%eax
0x00000000000011f7 <+142>: add %eax,-0x54(%rbp)

32 for(int i = 0; i < 3; i++) {
0x00000000000011fa <+145>: addl $0x1,-0x50(%rbp)
0x00000000000011fe <+149>: cmpl $0x2,-0x50(%rbp)
0x0000000000001202 <+153>: jle 0x11f4 <function_example+

38 f = arr[f++];
0x000000000000120b <+162>: mov -0x38(%rbp),%eax
0x000000000000120e <+165>: lea 0x1(%rax),%edx
0x0000000000001211 <+168>: mov %edx,-0x38(%rbp)
0x0000000000001214 <+171>: cltq
0x0000000000001216 <+173>: mov -0x20(%rbp,%rax,4),%eax
0x000000000000121a <+177>: mov %eax,-0x38(%rbp)

39
40 // Auto-decrement
41 int g = 2;
0x000000000000121d <+180>: movl $0x2,-0x34(%rbp)

42 g = arr[--g];
0x0000000000001224 <+187>: subl $0x1,-0x34(%rbp)
0x0000000000001228 <+191>: mov -0x34(%rbp),%eax
0x000000000000122b <+194>: cltq
0x000000000000122d <+196>: mov -0x20(%rbp,%rax,4),%eax
0x0000000000001231 <+200>: mov %eax,-0x34(%rbp)

43 // Print to avoid optimization
44 printf("%d %d %d %d %d %d\n", b, c, d, e, f, g, global_var);
45 0x0000000000001234 <+203>: mov 0x2dd6(%rip),%esi # 0x4010 <global_var>
0x000000000000123a <+209>: mov -0x38(%rbp),%r8d
0x000000000000123e <+213>: mov -0x3c(%rbp),%edi
0x0000000000001241 <+216>: mov -0x40(%rbp),%ecx
0x0000000000001244 <+219>: mov -0x44(%rbp),%edx
0x0000000000001247 <+222>: mov -0x48(%rbp),%eax
0x000000000000124a <+225>: push %rsi
0x000000000000124b <+226>: mov -0x34(%rbp),%esi
0x000000000000124e <+229>: push %rsi
0x000000000000124f <+230>: mov %r8d,%r9d
0x0000000000001252 <+233>: mov %edi,%r8d
0x0000000000001255 <+236>: mov %eax,%esi
0x0000000000001257 <+238>: lea 0xda6(%rip),%rdi # 0x2004
0x000000000000125e <+245>: mov $0x0,%eax
0x0000000000001263 <+250>: callq 0x1070 <printf@plt>
0x0000000000001268 <+255>: add $0x10,%rsp

46 }
0x000000000000126c <+259>: nop
0x000000000000126d <+260>: mov -0x8(%rbp),%rax
0x0000000000001271 <+264>: xor %fs:0x28,%rax
0x000000000000127a <+273>: je 0x1281 <function_example+280>
0x000000000000127c <+275>: callq 0x1060 <__stack_chk_fail@plt>
0x0000000000001281 <+280>: leaveq
0x0000000000001282 <+281>: retq

End of assembler dump.
(ndb) quit
```

Conclusion

Successfully explored all addressing modes